PALADIN SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

Oath of the Wyrmguard

Dragon-bonded knights who leap into battle on wyvern-back, and the order's executioners when one of their own falls to corruption.

V0.1 PLAYTEST THE DRAGOON INSPIRED BY FINAL FANTASY TACTICS

Inspired by the Dragoon of *Final Fantasy Tactics* and *Tactics Advance*: heavy armor, a lance, and an enemy who can never pin them down.

FEATURES	
3	Chosen Element
3	Dragoon's Leap
3	Channel Divinity: Wyrmkiller
7	Aura of the Wyrm-bond
7	Wyvern Steed
15	Wyrm's Counter
20	Wyrmguard Ascendant

Tenets of the Wyrmguard

- **Honor the Bond.** Dragons and their riders are kin. Defend them as you would yourself.

- **Watch the Flame.** Greed, rage, and pride corrupt wyrms and knights alike. Guard against it in others, and in yourself.
- **Strike True.** When one of your own falls to corruption, you end it swiftly. Mercy is a clean death, not a second chance.

Oath Spells

You always have these spells prepared once you reach the listed Paladin level.

PALADIN LEVEL	SPELLS
3	*Jump, Chromatic Orb*
5	*Dragon's Breath, Enhance Ability*
9	*Fly, Vampiric Touch*
13	*Freedom of Movement, Dimension Door*
17	*Hold Monster, Steel Wind Strike*

LEVEL 3

Chosen Element

When you finish a Long Rest, choose acid, cold, fire, lightning, or poison. Several Wyrmguard features refer to your chosen element.

LEVEL 3

Dragoon's Leap

As a Bonus Action, you leap up to a distance equal to your Speed. This movement doesn't provoke Opportunity Attacks and isn't slowed by Difficult Terrain, and you must land in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of a creature. That creature must succeed on a Strength saving throw against your spell save DC or have the Prone condition.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Proficiency Bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

Improved Leap (11th level). If you hit the creature you landed next to with a dragoon weapon (Spear, Trident, Pike, Glaive, Halberd, or Lance) on the same turn, the attack deals one extra die of the weapon's damage.

LEVEL 3

Channel Divinity: Wyrmkiller

As a Bonus Action, you expend one use of your Channel Divinity to mark a creature you can see within 60 feet of yourself for 1 minute. While marked, the creature has Disadvantage on saving throws against your Dragoon's Leap, and damage of your chosen element that you deal to it ignores Resistance.

If the marked creature is a Dragon, damage of your chosen element that you deal to it also treats Immunity as Resistance.

LEVEL 7

Aura of the Wyrm-bond

While you don't have the Incapacitated condition, you and your allies have Resistance to damage of your chosen element while in your Aura of Protection.

LEVEL 7

Wyvern Steed

When you cast *Find Steed*, you can have the steed appear as a wyvern. In this form, its creature type is Dragon and it has a Fly Speed equal to its Speed.

LEVEL 15

Wyrm's Counter

When a creature you can see within your reach hits you with an attack roll, you can take a Reaction to do one of the following: make one melee weapon attack against that creature, or move up to half your Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks. If you expend a use of your Dragoon's Leap, you can do both, in either order.

LEVEL 20

Wyrmguard Ascendant

As a Bonus Action, you take on draconic aspects for 10 minutes. For the duration:

- You have a Fly Speed equal to your Speed and can hover.
- Dragoon's Leap has no use limit.
- Once on each of your turns, you can replace one attack with a breath of your chosen element in a 30-foot Cone. Each creature in the area makes a Dexterity saving throw against your spell save DC, taking 6d10 damage of your chosen element on a failed save or half as much on a successful one.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a Long Rest unless you expend a level 5 spell slot to restore your use of it.

PLAYTEST NOTES

- **Leap vs. Smite:** both cost a Bonus Action. Confirm the competition feels like a real choice, not a trap.
- **Leap + Topple:** a Lance's Topple mastery gives a second shot at Prone on the same turn. Watch whether this trivializes Prone.
- **Wyvern at 7th:** check flight against your campaign's encounter design.
- **Busy 3rd level:** three features at once. Check whether new players find it overwhelming.
- **Capstone breath:** 6d10 is a placeholder. Compare against Holy Nimbus and Avenging Angel.

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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